

Risk Assessment No: WP-006		Task: Thickener — Operation, Rake Torque and Flocculant Dosing							
Prepared By: Derick Bibby				Date: 02.08.2026			RA Review Date: 01.08.2027		
				Reviewed By: Lee Hardy			Date: 02.08.2026		
PPE: Safety Footwear, High Visibility Jacket, High Visibility Trousers, Hard Hat, Gloves, Ear Defenders, Mask, Eye Protection									
Hazard	Persons at Risk	L	S	R	Control Measures	L	S	R	
Engulfment / drowning in thickener tank	Maintenance Cleaners	3	5	15	- Entry only under Confined Space Permit — see WP-011. - Full LOTO of feed, flocculant, rake drive and underflow pump. - Continuous gas monitor; top-man in constant view / voice contact. - Rescue tripod and winch rigged before entry. - Never enter partially drained tank until proved gas-free and physically isolated.	1	5	5	
Rake overload / mechanical failure during operation	Operator Maintenance	3	3	9	- Torque monitor with high-torque alarm and auto-lift on overload. - Underflow pump interlocked with rake torque — auto-lift if torque exceeds threshold. - Operator monitors HMI torque trend; investigate any rising baseline. - Never restart a stalled rake without first identifying and removing the cause.	1	3	3	
Chemical exposure — flocculant, lubricants, coolants, hydraulic fluid	Maintenance Operator	3	3	9	- COSHH assessment for every chemical on site; SDS held at MCC and maintenance office. - Chemical-resistant gloves and eye/face protection during handling and dosing. - Bunded storage; spill kits at each storage point. - Emergency eyewash station at MCC and picking station. - Waste chemicals disposed via licensed contractor; consignment notes retained.	1	3	3	
Chemical release from flocculant bulk storage	Maintenance Delivery drivers	2	3	6	- Bulk storage in a bunded IBC store; dosing lines routed away from walkways. - Delivery under permit with a trained supervisor; driver remains in view. - Spill kit and eyewash at delivery point. - COSHH assessment specific to the flocculant product held with SDS.	1	3	3	
Slips, trips and falls on the same level	All plant personnel	4	3	12	- Anti-slip walkways and stair-treads; wash-down at end of shift. - No trailing hoses or cables across walkways — stored on reels or coiled. - Immediate clean-up of oil, hydraulic fluid or fines spillage. - Adequate task lighting throughout the plant. - Correct footwear with slip-resistant sole to SRC.	2	3	6	
Contact with moving parts (drives, drums,	Operator Maintenance	4	5	20	- Fixed guards to BS EN ISO 14120 secured with tooled fasteners. - No guard removed unless the machine is locked off in accordance with FoxSafe Isolation &	1	5	5	

agitators, augers)	Contractors				Lock Out Procedure. • Emergency stops and pull-cord trip wires within reach; tested weekly. • Daily start-up checklist CL-WP-01 confirms all guards in place before running. • No loose clothing, jewellery or long hair uncovered.			
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